

# Decipher

## Pre-read briefing

A concise explanation of the problem, the architectural thesis, and why Experience Drivers may deserve to be treated as the primitive of customer experience.

*Core proposition: if Experience Drivers are truly the determinants of customer experience, they should not be treated merely as analytical outputs. They should be treated as stable operational objects.*

**Prepared as a meeting pre-read.** This document is written to be accessible to readers from inside or outside CX while preserving the core thesis of the work.

## 1. What this work is trying to address

Across customer experience, organizations have become much better at collecting signals, surfacing themes, identifying pain points, and even isolating the Drivers behind customer outcomes.

But one problem remains largely unresolved:

*the things organizations identify as the real determinants of experience are rarely preserved as stable operational units inside the business.*

As a result:

- the same Drivers reappear in later cycles
- improvement efforts often reset rather than compound
- actions become weakly anchored to the thing that caused the issue
- institutional learning fragments across teams, tools, and reporting periods

This work begins from a simple but important proposition:

*if Experience Drivers are truly the determinants of customer experience, they should not be treated merely as analytical outputs. They should be treated as stable operational objects.*

That is the central premise behind Decipher.

## 2. What is an Experience Driver?

In this architecture, an Experience Driver is the underlying determinant that materially shapes a customer experience outcome.

It is not:

- a comment
- a theme
- a score
- a sentiment label
- or a dashboard category

It is the more stable causal surface beneath those things.

Examples might include:

- Triage Efficiency in healthcare
- Pricing Transparency in retail

- Recommendation Relevance in digital commerce
- Claims Communication in insurance
- Onboarding Friction in fintech

In simple terms, an Experience Driver is the thing that is actually creating, degrading, or shaping the experience - the factor that the business ultimately needs to improve, maintain, or redesign.

### 3. Why Experience Driver is treated here as the primitive

A major part of this work is the claim that, within CX, the Experience Driver is the true primitive.

By primitive, I mean the smallest valid unit around which the rest of the system can reliably be built.

A true primitive should satisfy four criteria:

| Criterion                     | Meaning in this context                                                          |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Atomic</b>                 | It cannot be meaningfully subdivided without losing practical meaning.           |
| <b>Composable</b>             | It can combine with other dimensions to create higher-order constructs.          |
| <b>Semantically Stable</b>    | It means the same thing across contexts and over time.                           |
| <b>Operationally Complete</b> | It is sufficient to support real work without needing constant reinterpretation. |

The argument here is that many common CX units do not satisfy these conditions well enough.

- comments are too raw and fragmented
- themes are often too loose
- scores are abstractions rather than determinants
- emotions are powerful signals, but not the underlying object of management

The Experience Driver, by contrast, can serve as a stable anchor for diagnosis, action, evaluation, and memory.

That is why this work places it at the center.

## 4. The role of emotion in this architecture

Emotion is important in this system, but it is not treated as the primary object.

*The architecture does not assume that customer experience should be governed around emotion alone. It treats the Experience Driver as the object, and emotion as a weighting force acting on that object.*

In practice, that means emotion helps answer questions such as:

- how much pressure is associated with a given Driver
- how positive or negative its current state is
- how urgent or intense the issue feels
- how intervention should be prioritized

So emotion matters greatly, but it is not the unit being governed. The Driver is.

This is a deliberate design choice intended to avoid a common trap in experience systems: treating emotional interpretation as if it were itself the stable thing the business should manage.

## 5. The gap in current approaches

Most current CX and VoC systems are very capable at:

- signal collection
- text interpretation
- theme detection
- sentiment or emotion analysis
- identifying probable Drivers
- reporting and dashboarding

What they are less capable at is preserving the identified determinant as a durable unit through the full cycle of work.

In many organizations, the pattern still looks like this:

*Score -> Insight -> Deck -> Reprioritization*

The result is that the organization often becomes better at describing problems than governing them.

Decipher is based on a different logic:

*Signal -> Experience Driver -> State -> Action -> Outcome -> Memory*

That shift is the essence of the architecture.

## 6. What Decipher is proposing

Decipher is an attempt to create a more durable operating layer for experience management by treating each Experience Driver as a governed unit with continuity over time.

In practical terms, that means a Driver is not simply identified and reported. It is given:

- a stable identity
- a measurable state
- action linkage
- outcome comparison
- and memory

This allows the organization to move from one-off interpretation toward cumulative management.

**At a high level, the architecture works as follows:**

| Step                                          | Description                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>a. Signals are processed</b>               | Customer or human signals are interpreted and mapped to the relevant Experience Driver.                               |
| <b>b. The Driver is instantiated as state</b> | The system maintains a structured representation of the Driver's current condition.                                   |
| <b>c. Action is anchored to the Driver</b>    | Interventions are linked back to the determinant they are intended to affect.                                         |
| <b>d. Outcomes are evaluated</b>              | Post-intervention comparison makes it possible to assess whether the Driver's condition actually changed.             |
| <b>e. Learning is retained</b>                | The system preserves what happened, what was attempted, and what changed, so future cycles do not begin from scratch. |

This is why the work should not be thought of only as analytics. It is better understood as a state-action-memory architecture for experience determinants.

## 7. What has been built so far

This work is not just conceptual.

Over the past two years, I have developed the architecture and built prototype logic around it. The prototype is designed to show that the thesis can be operationalized rather than merely described.

The work includes:

- a structured Experience Driver framework
- state logic tied to the Driver
- orchestration logic for action units
- evaluation logic for post-action assessment
- memory-oriented thinking around continuity and institutional learning
- vertical exploration across multiple domains

The current form is founder-built and prototype-stage, but the point of the work so far has been to validate the underlying logic and demonstrate that the model can support more than reporting or categorization.

## 8. Why this may matter now

This work may matter more now than it would have a few years ago.

AI is rapidly improving the speed and cost of:

- signal extraction
- summarization
- classification
- theme surfacing
- and even recommendation generation

*the long-term differentiator is unlikely to be signal interpretation alone.*

If every system can summarize feedback and identify patterns, then the more important question becomes:

*what structure turns those signals into durable organizational progress?*

Decipher is an attempt to answer that question by giving the underlying determinants of experience a more durable computational and operational form.

## 9. Why this is broader than classic CX software

Although the current framing often starts in CX, the underlying logic is broader.

Any domain that repeatedly interprets unstructured human signals faces a similar challenge:

- recurring diagnosis
- fragmented ownership
- weak continuity between interpretation and action
- and limited institutional learning at the determinant level

That includes areas such as:

- healthcare experience
- employee experience
- service operations
- trust-sensitive environments
- compliance-adjacent human interactions
- and other domains where qualitative human signals matter operationally

For that reason, this work may be better understood not only as a CX thesis, but as part of a broader human-signal architecture.

## 10. The core question this work raises

The simplest way to understand Decipher is through a single question:

*If organizations already know that Drivers are the real determinants of customer experience, why are those Drivers still treated as disposable analytical artifacts rather than governed operational entities?*

Everything in this architecture flows from that question.

## 11. What this briefing is meant to do

This document is not intended to claim that every part of the final answer has already been solved.

It is meant to make clear that there is a serious architectural thesis here:

- Experience Drivers may be the correct primitive for CX
- current systems may stop too early at interpretation
- the missing layer may be continuity around the determinant itself

- and there may be real value in formalizing that determinant into state, action, outcome, and memory

That is the work I have been pursuing.